

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 7, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 36:32–38

32 "Not for your sake do I do this," says the Lord God, "let it be known to you. Be ashamed and confounded for your own ways, O house of Israel!"

33 'Thus says the Lord God: "On the day that I cleanse you from all your iniquities, I will also enable you to dwell in the cities, and the ruins shall be rebuilt.

34 The desolate land shall be tilled instead of lying desolate in the sight of all who pass by.

35 So they will say, 'This land that was desolate has become like the garden of Eden; and the wasted, desolate, and ruined cities are now fortified and inhabited.'

36 Then the nations which are left all around you shall know that I, the Lord, have rebuilt the ruined places and planted what was desolate. I, the Lord, have spoken it, and I will do it."

37 'Thus says the Lord God: "I will also let the house of Israel inquire of Me to do this for them: I will increase their men like a flock.

38 Like a flock offered as holy sacrifices, like the flock at Jerusalem on its feast days, so shall the ruined cities be filled with flocks of men. Then they shall know that I am the Lord.'""

II. Key Summary

- God opens by making it clear that He is not doing this for Israel's sake, and He tells them to be ashamed of their own past ways (v. 32).
 - God promises that on the day He cleanses them, the cities will be lived in again, the ruins rebuilt, and the wasteland farmed again — until people passing by say the land has become like the garden of Eden (vv. 33–35).
 - God says He will increase the house of Israel like a flock, that they will ask Him for this and He will do it, and that the ruined cities will be filled with people (vv. 37–38).
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III. Passage Analysis

God rebuilds the very ground that was wrecked

This is a prophecy that Israel's ruined land will become a blessed land, like the garden of Eden before the fall. The passage stresses that this restoration is accomplished through God's work of creation, just as God created Eden. Though humanity fell and rebelled, God's work of redemption restores the original state of creation. [1]

God does not go find a clean patch of new ground and start over — He repairs the burned-down city and the trampled field itself. The same creative power that made Eden gets used on the place you assumed was past saving.

He already promised it, and He still wants you to ask

I trust we all feel the missionary spirit; we all long to see the kingdom of the Lord come, and to see the converts in Zion multiplied. But God has appended to the granting of our desire that we should pray for it: we must plead and enquire, or else the increase will be withheld. [2]

Verse 37 is striking: God has clearly already promised this restoration, yet He says "I will also let the house of Israel inquire of Me to do this for them." He wants more than the job done — He wants a relationship where you actually speak up.

IV. Reflection Question

Israel was told to be ashamed of their own ways, and they still received the promise of rebuilding — hope at their lowest point. Why do you think God was still willing to give grace like that?

In verse 36 God says He will "rebuild the ruined places and plant what was desolate." What ground of yours is lying desolate right now, waiting for God to restore it?

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (.org), Holy Bible Intensive Reading Commentary,

notes on Ezekiel 36, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT36.htm>

[2] Enduring Word (David Guzik), Ezekiel 36 commentary (quoting Charles Spurgeon),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-36/>